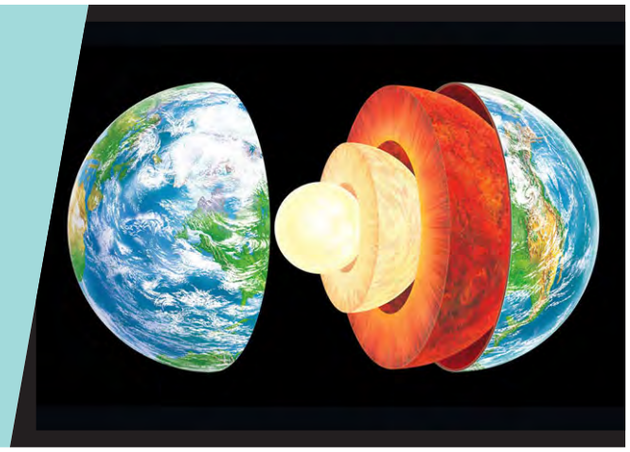
Unit -1

Interior of the Earth



Learning Objectives

- To know about the interior of the earth
- To understand the movements of earth plates
- To learn about earthquakes and volcanoes

VVRXM5

Introduction

The earth, our homeland, is a dynamic planet. The earth's surface has lofty mountains, high plateaus, large plains and deep valleys etc. The earth's surface is constantly undergoing changes inside and outside. Have you ever wondered what lies in the interior of the earth? What is the earth made up of? Let us learn about this in detail.

Interior of the Earth

The structure of the earth may be compared to that of an apple.On the basis of the study of earthquake waves the spherical earth is found to be three concentric layers. They are:

1. The crust,
2. The mantle and
3. The core.

1. The Crust

The crust is the outermost layer of the earth. Its thickness varies from 5 to 30 km. It is about 35 km on the continental masses and only 5 km on the ocean floors. Despite greater thickness, the continental crust is less dense than the oceanic crust because it is made of both light and dense rock types. The oceanic crust is composed mostly of dense rocks such as basalt.

DO YOU KNOW?

Earth is called as blue Planet. 71% of the earth is covered by water.

The crust comprises two of distinct parts. The upper part consists of granite rocks and forms the continents. It has the main mineral constituents of silica and alumina. So it is referred to as Sial. It has an average density of 2.7g/cm^3.

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